

*What do you feel is the single most important contribution of Italian Americans to society?*

The contributions of Italian Americans are plenty, but I have a strong love for the arts, and the expression that art allows for. Italian Americans have made a profound impact on the arts with some of the most influential musicians, actors, and filmmakers.

To begin with music, I have a special affinity for jazz, which means that I, of course, *love* Frank Sinatra. Even those who do not share that sentiment cannot deny the overwhelming influence that he has had not only on jazz, but the music industry as a whole. His popular cover of *Fly Me to the Moon* will live on as one of the world's greatest songs. Transitioning into pop, two of the most iconic women in the genre as of late are of Italian American descent. Lady Gaga, with her roots to Sicily, and Ariana Grande, with her roots to Sicily and Abruzzo. Lady Gaga's 2008 hit *Poker Face* was on loop for my childhood, while she just won 2 Grammy's at the 2026 award show, upping her total wins to 16 and nominations to 45. Ariana Grande, on the other hand, has made an effort to participate in both film/television and music. Her songs *7 Rings* and *Thank U, Next* have both been first on the Billboard Hot 100. Meanwhile, she starred in the musical adaptation films *Wicked* and *Wicked: For Good*, this coming years after she got her start in Nickelodeon kids shows *Victorious* and *Sam & Cat*.

In film, Francis Ford Coppola is easily one of the most influential directors, with his work on the Godfather Trilogy. Furthermore, Sylvester Stallone is a wildly popular director and actor. Stallone is best known for his work on the Rocky franchise and the Rambo franchise. In Rocky, he starred in and wrote all 6 films and directed 5 of the 6 films. In Rambo, he starred in and co-wrote all 5 of the films and directed 1 of the 5 films.

The profound impact of Italian Americans on society is not limited to these individuals, nor is it limited to these fields, but this should serve as a testament to the incredible things that Italian Americans are capable of achieving.